

Travel and transit

Improvements in transportation, from cars and ships to trains and planes, have radically changed the way we live, work, travel, and trade. Trips that once took months now take hours, and journeys that were once impossible are now a reality, as state-of-the-art spacecraft prove that, for humankind, not even outer space is beyond reach.

Two wheels

Draisienne

Where Mannheim, Germany
When 1817

German inventor Karl von Drais created the first bicycle—the *draisienne*. Riders pushed themselves along with their feet until versions with pedals were developed. Two-wheeled transportation evolved further with the invention of the motorcycle in 1885.



Iron steamship

Aaron Manby

Where Staffordshire, England
When 1822

The *Aaron Manby*, named after the British engineer who built it, was the first steamship made of iron to sail on the sea. The ship completed its maiden voyage from London to Paris in 1822. In 1845, the SS *Great Britain* was the first iron steamer to sail across the Atlantic.



Train travel

Stephenson's Rocket

Where Rainhill, England
When 1829

Although the steam locomotive had been invented in 1803, it was British engineers George and Robert Stephenson who really set the railroad revolution in motion. Their *Rocket* reached a record-breaking speed of 36mph (58kph) in a competition in 1829, and was used on the world's first intercity railroad, which opened the following year.



Into the air

Wright Flyer

Where Kitty Hawk, North Carolina
When 1903

US brothers Orville and Wilbur Wright made the first powered airplane flight in their *Flyer*. Though the flight only lasted for 12 seconds, it paved the way for future advances in aviation. Less than 50 years later, the first commercial jet airliner flew from London, UK, to Johannesburg, South Africa, opening up worldwide air travel.

